HOW DO PARENTAL SOCIOECONOMIC RESOURCES SHAPE CHILDREN'S OCCUPATIONAL OUTCOMES? A QUANTILE-BASED ANALYSIS USING CFPS (2010–2022)

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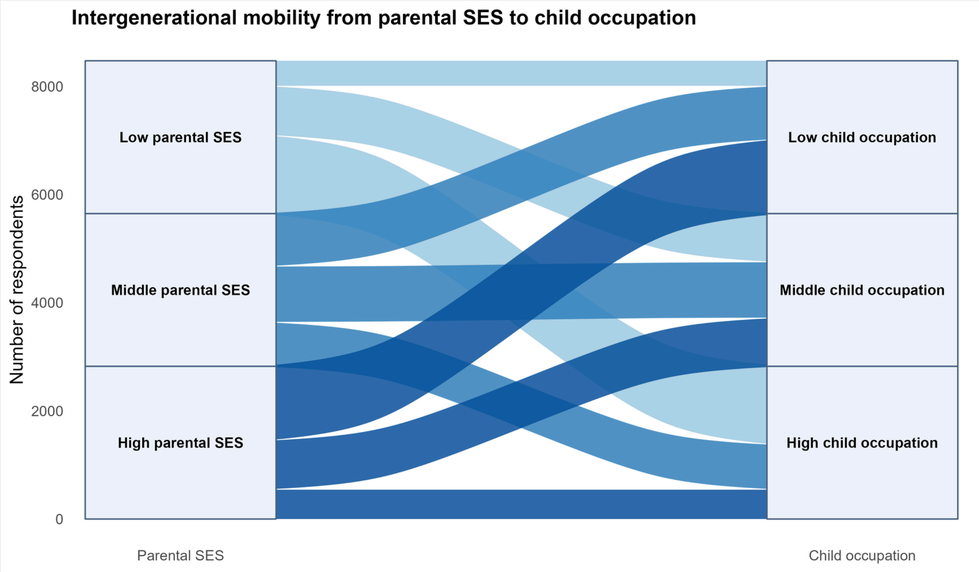
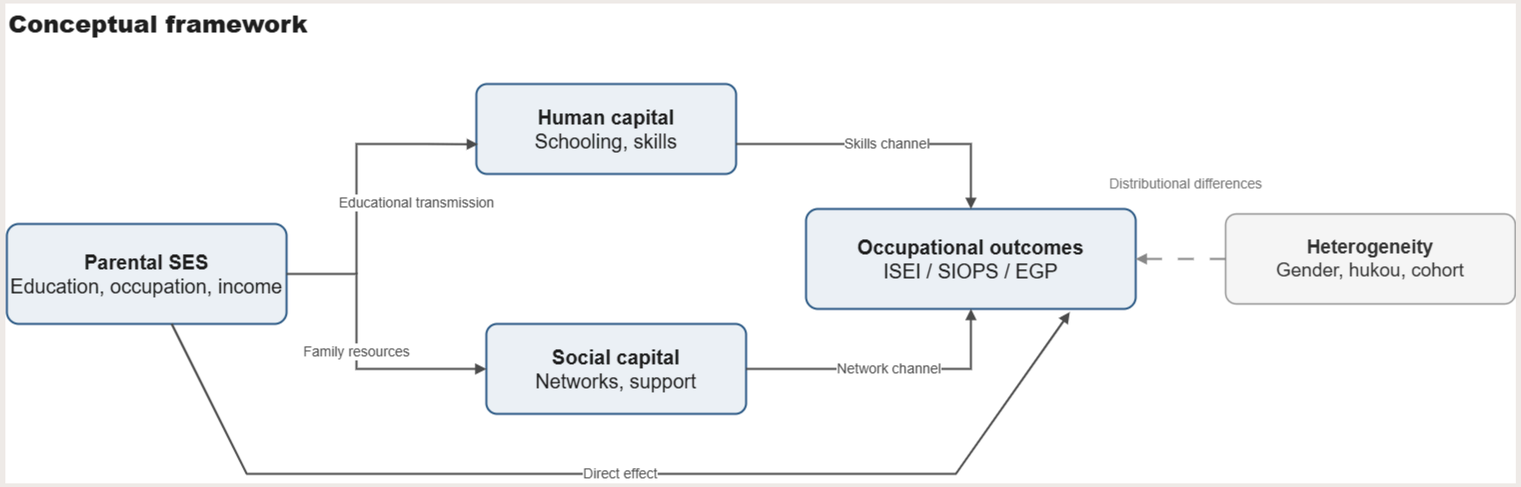
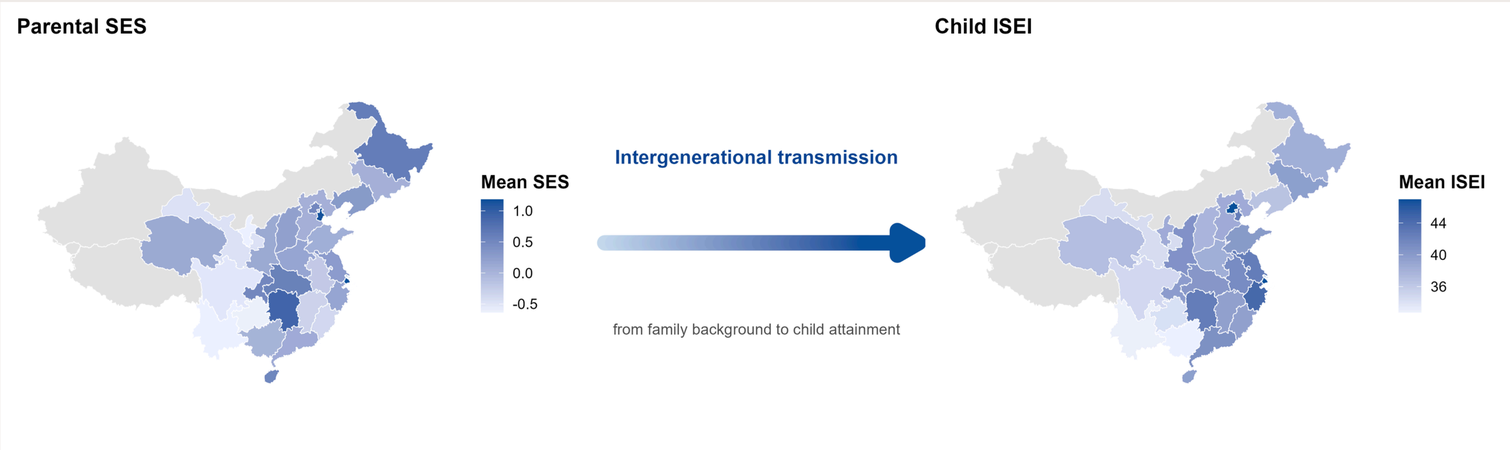
Research Question

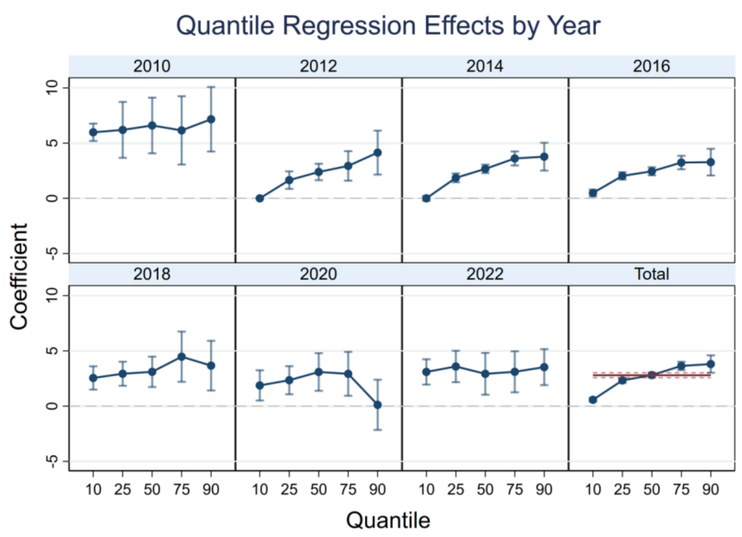
- Do children from higher-SES families achieve better occupational outcomes?
- Is the intergenerational association stronger at the top or bottom of the outcome distribution?
- What mechanisms transmit parental advantage to children?

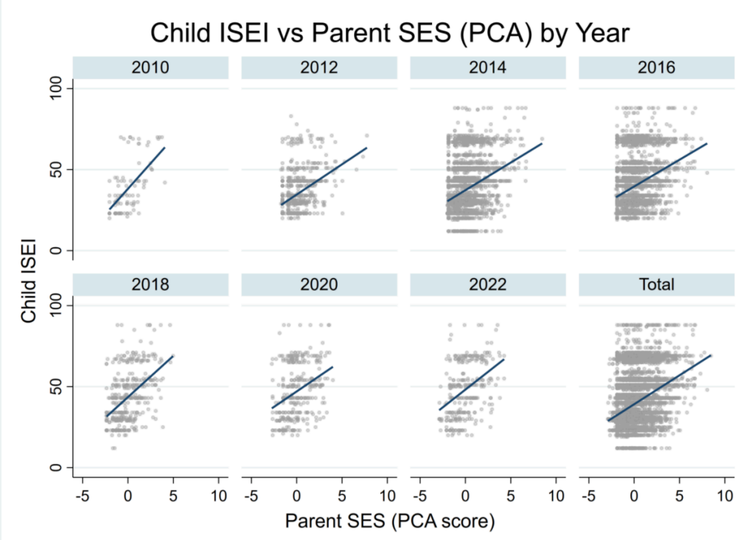


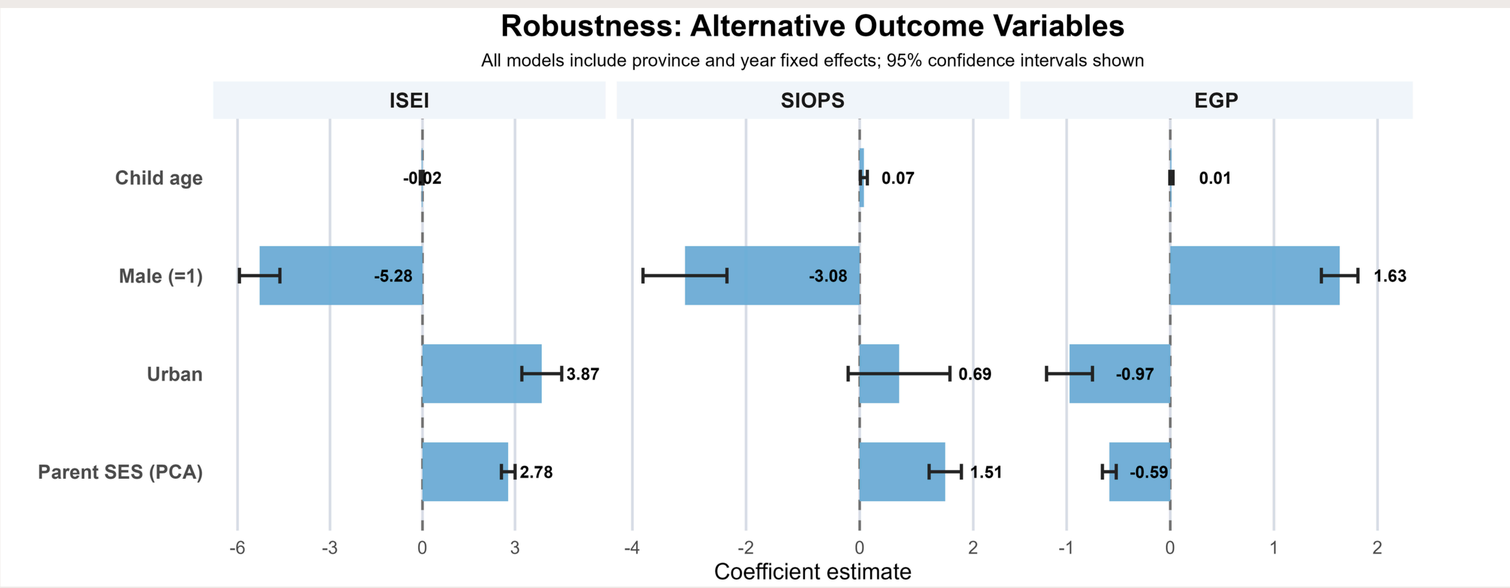
Key Finding



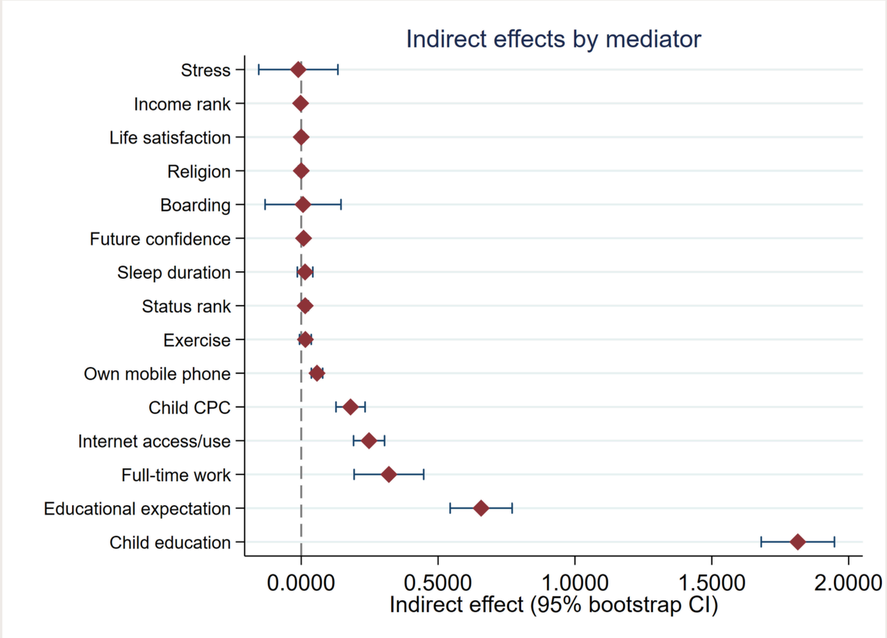




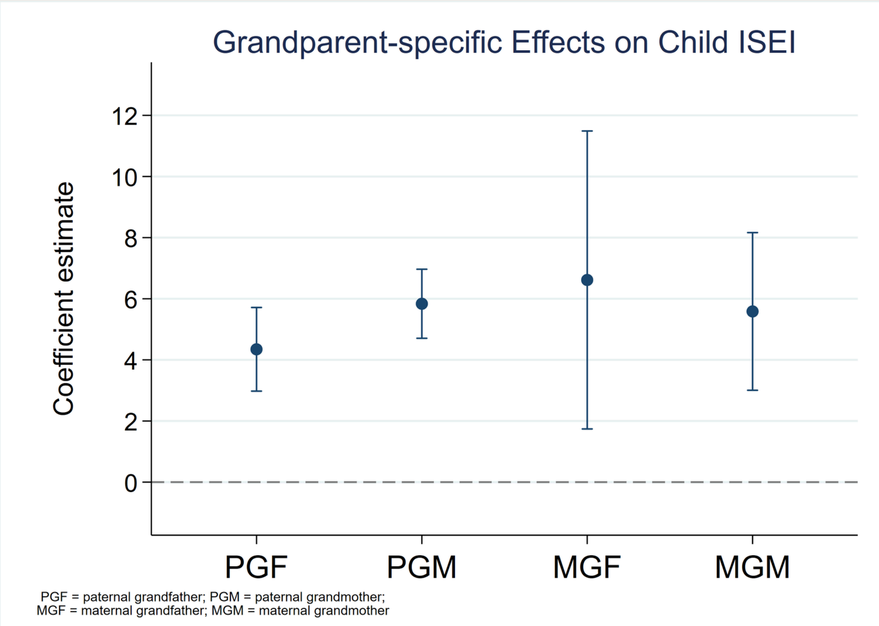




Mechanism



- Parental SES may affect children's occupational outcomes through educational attainment, social capital, political connections, and early-life family environment.
- We estimate indirect effects using a mediation framework and compare the magnitude of different channels.



- Grandparents' socioeconomic resources remain positively associated with child ISEI even after focusing on parent–child transmission.
- This pattern suggests that family advantage may persist across more than two generations.
- The effect sizes vary across paternal and maternal grandparents, implying that multigenerational transmission is not uniform within families.

Conclusion & Ref

- Occupational advantage is persistently transmitted across generations in China.
- Educational inequality is a central driver of intergenerational occupational inequality.
- Policies promoting equal educational opportunities may improve social mobility.

- Institute of Social Science Survey, Peking University. China Family Panel Studies (CFPS), 2010–2022.
- Xie, Y., Hu, J., & Zhang, C. (2014/2015). Studies introducing the CFPS dataset and its national representativeness.